KALSHI BOT

User Manual

Calls, live odds and an honest scorecard for Kalshi's 15-minute Bitcoin markets.

Version 2.24.0 · macOS 27.2 or later · © 2026 John Aldrich



Kalshi Bot follows every Kalshi KXBTC15M window. It makes a call at the minute you choose, shows you the live market and the evidence behind the call, suggests entries and exits for your trading style, and scores every result against Kalshi's own price. This manual explains every card, chart and setting.

© 2026 John Aldrich · MIT License · github.com/jaldrich2023/KalshiBot

Contents

01 **Getting started**
Before you begin · First launch · The toolbar · Popover tips

02 **How the markets work**

03 **The Dashboard**
Current Window · Prediction · Accuracy · Model · The 60-second average chart · The 1-minute candles chart · Reversal Risk

04 **Trade recommendations**
Trading styles · The recommendation · Call settings · Your position · Stop-loss and take-profit lines · Entry and exit alerts

05 **Indicators**
Model inputs · Context only · What has been tested

06 **Performance**
Hover for details

07 **Prediction Log**

08 **Activity**

09 **How the model learns**

10 **Your data**

11 **Troubleshooting**

12 **Legal**

01 Getting started

Before you begin

> **Kalshi Bot isn't financial advice.** It gives statistical estimates for information and education only. Every call is a probability, not a certainty: a 70% call is expected to miss about 3 times in 10, and past accuracy doesn't guarantee future results, and event contracts carry a real risk of loss. You're responsible for your own trading decisions.

You need:

- a Mac running macOS 27.2 or later,
- an internet connection.

You don't need a Kalshi account or any API keys. Kalshi Bot reads only public market data, and it **never places orders**. Any trade you make, you make yourself on Kalshi.

First launch

1. Open Kalshi Bot. It starts automatically, and the status pill at the top left of the toolbar turns to **Live**. The window has a fixed size of 2,400 × 1,600 points; on a smaller screen it shrinks to fit and the dashboard scrolls inside it.
2. The **Model** card shows "Rebuilding past windows…". Kalshi Bot downloads up to 180 days of Kalshi market history and Coinbase 1-minute candles, then rebuilds each past window as it looked at the call. This takes a few minutes the first time. The download is saved, so later launches fetch only what's new.
3. When the current window reaches the call time (+3 minutes by default), the **Prediction** card locks a call: Up or Down, with a probability.
4. When the window closes and Kalshi settles it, the call is scored, the **Accuracy** card updates, and the model retrains.

While it's running, Kalshi Bot keeps your Mac from sleeping, so it doesn't miss a window (turn off **Keep Mac awake** in the Strategy card to allow sleep). Click **Stop** in the toolbar to pause it; click **Start** to resume.

The toolbar

Item	What it does
Status pill	**Live** while the bot is running.
Tabs	Dashboard, Indicators, Performance, Prediction Log and Activity.
Copy CSV	Copies the whole prediction log to the clipboard as CSV, for a spreadsheet.
Start / Stop	Starts or pauses the bot.

Popover tips

Every field explains itself. Rest the pointer on any figure, label, setting or button for a moment and a popover opens with its name and a fuller explanation: what it measures, how it's calculated and how to read it. Moving away, clicking, typing or scrolling closes it. In the Prediction Log and the

Performance tab's charts and tables, hovering opens the detailed breakdown for that window or period instead.

02 How the markets work

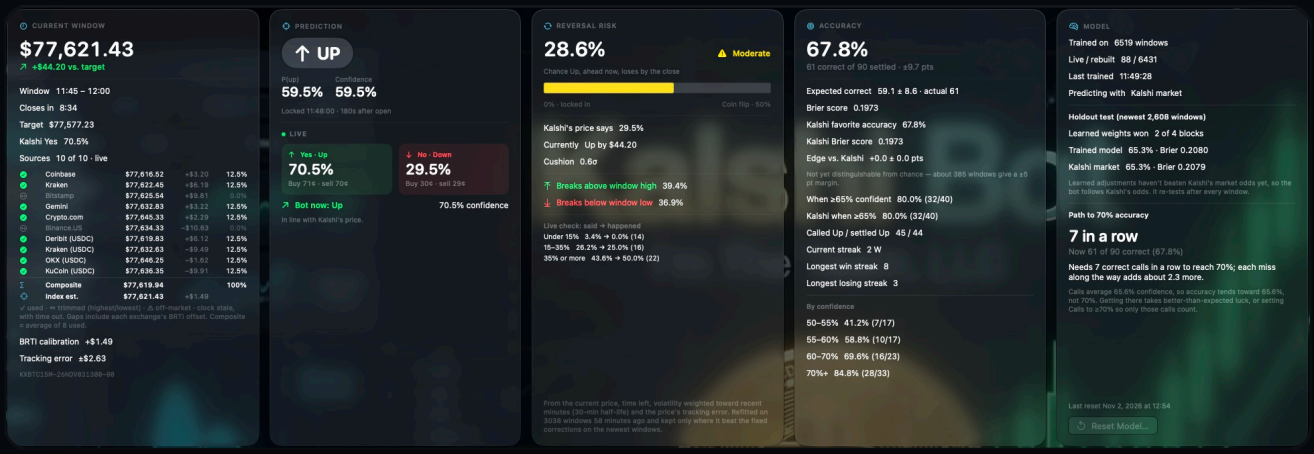
Each KXBTC15M market covers one 15-minute window, for example 5:00–5:15 PM Eastern. It asks a single question: **will Bitcoin settle at or above the target?**

- **The target** is the CF Benchmarks Bitcoin Real Time Index (BRTI), averaged over the 60 seconds before the window opens.
- **The settlement** is the same 60-second average over the last minute of the window.
- **Yes** pays $1 if it settles at or above the target ("Up"). **No** pays $1 if it settles below ("Down").
- A contract's price, between 1¢ and 99¢, is the market's probability. Yes at 62¢ means the market gives Up about a 62% chance.

Kalshi charges a taker fee on each trade, rounded up to the next cent: 7% × price × (1 – price) per contract. Kalshi Bot includes this fee, and half the bid/ask spread, in every edge and profit figure it shows.

Because both the target and the settlement are 60-second averages, the last minute matters a lot. Once the settlement minute starts, every second that passes locks in part of the answer. Kalshi Bot's odds take that into account.

03 The Dashboard



The top row: current window, prediction, accuracy and model

Current Window

- **The price** is Kalshi Bot's estimate of the BRTI right now, with how far it is above or below the target.
- **Window, Closes in, Target, Kalshi Yes** show the window's times, the time left, the target price, and Kalshi's live Yes price.
- **Sources** lists the ten exchange feeds: Coinbase, Kraken, Bitstamp, Gemini, Crypto.com, Binance.US, Deribit (USDC), Kraken (USDC), OKX (USDC) and KuCoin (USDC). Each row shows the latest price, the gap to the composite (after that exchange's offset), and its weight. A ✓ means the source is in use. A source is dropped when its price is off-market (more than 0.05% from the median) or its feed has gone stale; instead of a weight, it then shows how long it's been out. With five or more sources, the highest and lowest are trimmed. Hover a row for its offset and how often its stream has reconnected.
- **Per-exchange offsets.** At every window open, each exchange's 60-second average is compared with Kalshi's official target. Once three exchanges have been measured at six opens, each one's typical gap (its median offset) is added to its price before averaging. Exchanges that haven't been measured yet use the typical offset of the others. This keeps the composite steady when a source drops out or comes back.
- **Composite** is the weighted average of the sources in use. Once the offsets are measured, an exchange whose gap to the official index is steady counts more than one whose gap wanders, up to 25% each; until then all count equally. The weight column shows each exchange's share. **Index est.** adds the **BRTI calibration**, a running correction for whatever gap remains.
- **Tracking error** is how far the index estimate typically was (the median) from Kalshi's official target at recent opens. Only windows that finish within about that much of their target are at risk of being misjudged.
- The window's ticker is shown at the bottom, for example `KXBTC15M-26NOV021815-15`.

Prediction

Before the call time, the card says "No prediction locked for this window" and shows the live view only. At the call time it locks:

- **The call:** a large **UP** or **DOWN**, with P(up) and the confidence (the probability of the side called).

- **Calls like this:** how often past calls in the same 5-point confidence band, at the same call minute, were right. For example: "Calls like this (70–75% at +3 min) won 77% of 1,448 past windows."
- **Live:** Kalshi's Yes and No prices right now, as percentages, with the buy and sell prices in cents.
- **Bot now:** what the model would say from the current price. This is for information only; the locked call doesn't change.

Accuracy

The scorecard for every settled call:

- **Accuracy**, with how many were correct and a 95% margin of error.
- **Expected correct:** how many the bot's own probabilities said should be right, with a 95% range. If the actual number is inside the range, the difference is ordinary luck.
- **Brier score:** the average squared error of the probabilities. Lower is better; 0.25 is a coin flip.
- **Kalshi favorite accuracy, Kalshi Brier score, Edge vs. Kalshi:** the same measures for Kalshi's own price on the same windows, and the difference with its margin of error.
- **When ≥65% confident:** accuracy on the more confident calls, for the bot and for Kalshi.
- **Streaks:** the current streak, the longest win streak and the longest losing streak.
- **By confidence:** accuracy in each confidence band. Well-calibrated calls are right about as often as their confidence says. For example, 55–60% calls should lose about 4 times in 10.

If **Calls** is set to confident calls only (see chapter 4), the card says how many low-confidence windows were skipped.

Model

- **Trained on:** the windows the model learned from. **Live / rebuilt** splits them into windows the bot watched live and windows rebuilt from history.
- **Predicting with: Kalshi market** while learned adjustments haven't beaten Kalshi's own odds, or **Learned weights** once they have.
- **Holdout test:** the trained model and Kalshi's price, scored walk-forward on the newest 40% of windows. That stretch is split into four blocks in time order, and each block is scored by a model fitted only on the windows before it. **Learned weights won** shows how many blocks the learned weights beat Kalshi in.
- **Path to 70% accuracy:** the number of correct calls in a row needed to bring overall accuracy to 70%, or, once it's there, how many misses in a row it can absorb. Each miss on the way adds about 2.3 more needed. The note underneath compares the goal with the calls' average confidence, which is where accuracy tends over time.
- **Reset Model…** offers two choices: reset only the model, or clear all data. See chapter 10.

The 60-second average chart



The 60-second average chart, with stop-loss and take-profit

This chart follows the same 60-second average that Kalshi settles on, across the whole window.

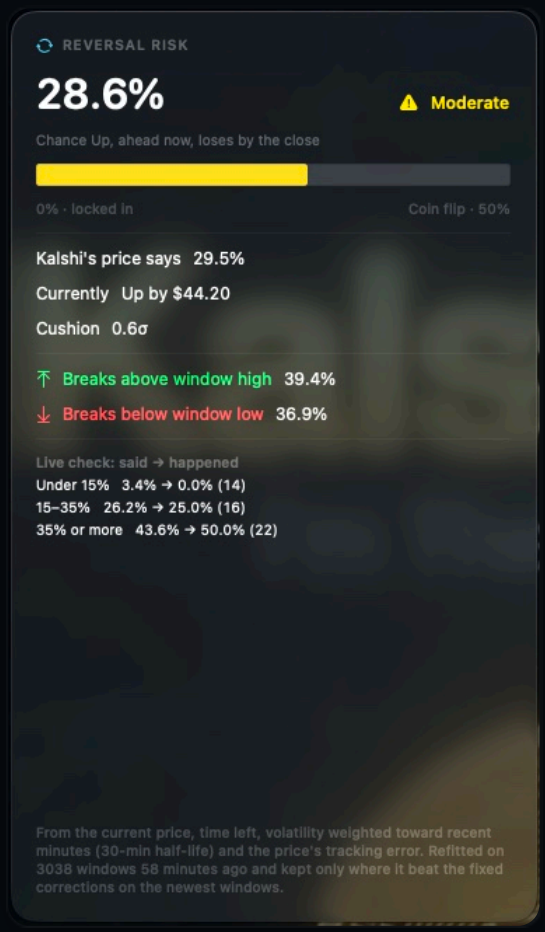
- **Target:** the dashed line the window must finish at or above for Up.
- **High and Low:** the highest and lowest values the 60-second average has actually reached in this window, with the time and the chance of a new high or low before the close.
- **Now, Trend and Projected:** the current value, the trend over the last few minutes, and the projected close, with the likely close range shaded.
- **Settlement minute:** the shaded final minute.
- **Stop-loss and Take profit:** once a call is locked, these show where to exit the side that was called. Each label says what the contract would sell for at that price and your profit or loss at your stake. See chapter 4.

Use **Layers** at the top right to show or hide each element: the 60s average, Now, Target, Settlement minute, High/Low, Close range, Trend, Projection, and Stop & take profit. Labels are arranged so they don't overlap one another, the lines, or the Now dot.

The 1-minute candles chart

The same window as 1-minute candles, with its own **Layers** menu. The **Candle pattern** card beside it names any recognized pattern in the latest candles, such as a hammer, an engulfing pattern, a doji or three white soldiers, and says whether it gives this window an edge. Patterns are informational only; they aren't model inputs.

Reversal Risk



The reversal risk card

- **The headline percentage** is the chance that the side ahead now loses by the close. It's labeled **Low** (under 15%), **Moderate** (15–35%) or **High** (35% or more). The bar runs from 0% (locked

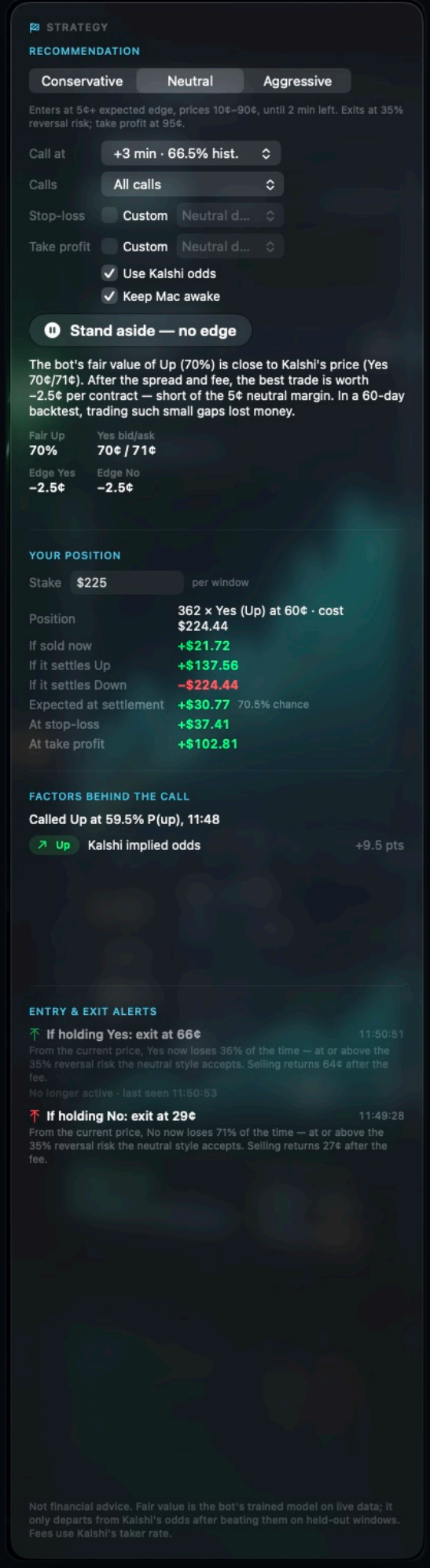
in) to 50% (a coin flip: the price sitting on the target, the most a reversal can be).

- **Kalshi's price says:** the same outcome priced by Kalshi (1 – the leading side's price), for comparison.
- **Currently, Cushion:** how far the price is from the target, and that distance in units of expected movement (σ).
- **Momentum strength:** how strongly the price has moved over the last 3 minutes compared with normal, and whether it's moving with or against the side that's winning.
- **Breaks above window high, Breaks below window low:** the chance of a new high or low before the close.
- **Live check:** every minute the card's figure is logged, and scored once the window settles. For each band (under 15%, 15–35%, 35% or more) the card shows what it said on average and how often the leading side actually lost. Close agreement means the card is well calibrated; small counts are noisy.

These odds come from a random-walk model of the 60-second average. The uncertainty includes the price's **tracking error**, so a few-dollar cushion isn't treated as certain. After each history rebuild (at most hourly), the bot refits the corrections from the saved history. It fits on the older 80% of windows, scores on the newest 20%, and keeps a refit only where it does better. It tries three volatility weightings (the last hour equally, or a 30- or 15-minute half-life) and a blend with Kalshi's price.

In the Nov 3 backtest of 3,038 windows, the card was well calibrated: when it said about 10%, 20%, 30% and 43%, the leading side lost 8%, 22%, 32% and 44% of the time. That matched Kalshi's price (Brier 0.1611 vs. 0.1615), and blending the two didn't help, so the card shows Kalshi's figure alongside rather than mixed in. The refit improved the breakout odds, and volatility weighted toward the last 30 minutes scored best. Momentum, pullbacks, wicks, RSI and target crossings were all tested as early warnings; none added anything.

04 Trade recommendations



The Strategy card

The **Strategy** card on the right of the dashboard turns the call and Kalshi's prices into a

suggestion. It never trades for you.

Trading styles

Choose **Conservative**, **Neutral** or **Aggressive** at the top of the card:

Setting	Conservative	Neutral	Aggressive
Minimum edge to enter (per contract, after fees)	8¢	5¢	3¢
Contract prices it will suggest	25¢–75¢	10¢–90¢	1¢–99¢
No new entries with less than	5 min left	2 min left	1 min left
Exit when the side's chance of losing reaches	25%	35%	50%
Default stop-loss (share of the price paid)	30%	50%	70%
Take-profit (share of the most it could sell for)	60%	80%	95%
Trailing stop keeps at least this share of the best gain	60%	50%	30%

The recommendation

The headline is one of:

- **Buy Yes** or **Buy No**, when the side called is cheap enough compared with the bot's fair value to clear the style's edge, after the fee and half the spread. Entries are suggested only on the side the bot called.
- **Stand aside — no edge**, when the price is close to fair value. This is the usual case when the bot follows Kalshi's odds.
- **Stand aside — against the call**, when the only edge would be on the side the bot didn't call.

Underneath, the card shows the bot's fair value, Kalshi's Yes bid and ask, and the edge on each side.

Call settings

Setting	Choices	What it does
Preset	Standard (+3 min, ≥60%) or High hit rate (+9 min, ≥70%)	Sets **Call at** and **Calls** together. High hit rate was right 88% of the time in 6,459 past windows (Standard: 73%) and calls about 71% of windows. It raises accuracy, not profit: those contracts cost correspondingly more. Changing either setting by hand shows **Custom**.
Call at	+3 to +12 min	When each window's call locks. The menu shows how often calls at that minute were right in history. Later calls are right more often, but Kalshi's price has moved too. Changing it rebuilds the model's history at the new time.
Calls	All calls, or only ≥60% (the default), 65%, 70%, 75% or 80% confident	Calls below the threshold are marked **No call** and left out of accuracy and performance. Every window is still logged and trained on.
Stop-loss	Style default, or Custom: 5%–70%	The share of the price paid that you're willing to lose before exiting.
Take profit	Style default, or Custom: 5%–100%	The gain on the price paid at which to sell. If the gain isn't possible at the current price, the card says it's unreachable and no line is drawn.
Use Kalshi odds	On or off	When on, the model starts from Kalshi's price and adjusts it only with signals that have proven themselves. **Leave this on.** With it off, the model uses price signals alone, which is much less accurate and can disagree with the market for no good reason; the card shows a warning while it's off.
Keep Mac awake	On (default) or off	Stops the Mac from idle-sleeping while the bot runs. With it off, the Mac can sleep and the windows during sleep are missed.

Your position

Enter your **Stake** per window. Once a call is locked, the card shows:

- how many whole contracts the stake buys on the called side, at the ask, and what they cost,
- **If sold now:** the result of selling at the bid, after the fee,
- **If it settles Up / Down:** the result at settlement either way,
- **Expected at settlement:** the average of the two, weighted by the bot's probability,
- **At stop-loss** and **At take profit:** the result if you exit at those lines.

Stop-loss and take-profit lines

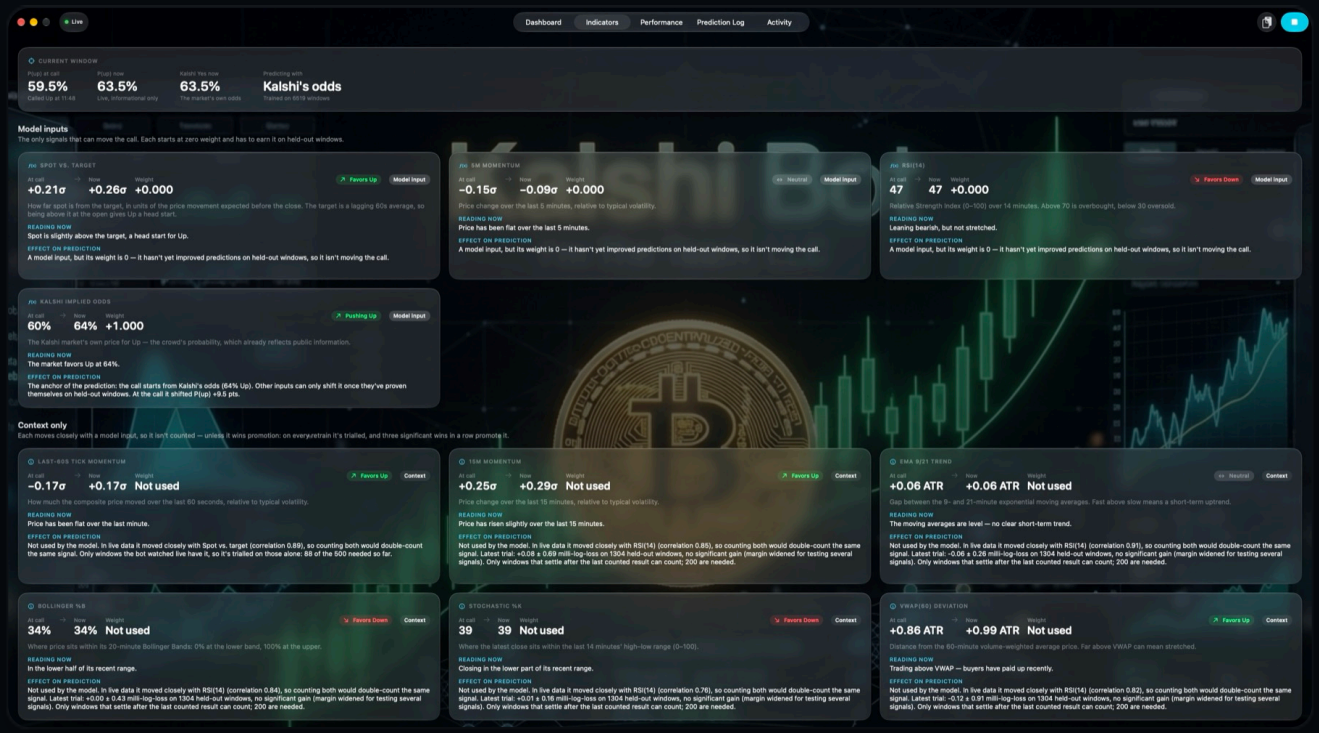
Both lines are drawn on the 60-second average chart, in Bitcoin prices, so you can see how far the price has to move to reach them. They're based on the current market: the time left, volatility, and how far Kalshi's price has strayed from the bot's odds.

- **Stop-loss** limits your loss if the call is going wrong. After you've been in profit by at least 10¢ (or a quarter of the best gain), it becomes a **trailing stop**, which keeps at least the style's share of the best gain so far.
- **Take profit** locks in a gain when the call is going right.

Entry and exit alerts

The **Entry & exit alerts** list shows each suggestion as it happens, with the time and the reason. For example: "If holding Yes: exit at 14¢. From the current price, Yes now loses 86% of the time...". Alerts that no longer apply are marked **No longer active**.

05 Indicators



The Indicators tab

The **Indicators** tab shows every signal the bot computes, each on its own card:

- **At call / Now:** the value when the call locked, and the value now.
- **Weight:** the signal's weight in the model. **Not used** means it isn't a model input.
- **Favors Up / Favors Down:** the direction the signal points.
- **Reading now:** what the value means in plain language.
- **Effect on prediction:** whether it's moving the call and why.
- **Windows:** how many settled windows have this signal (live windows, for live-only signals).
- **Promotion** (context signals only): its streak of counted results, how many windows until its next result can count, and the fewest windows before it could be promoted.

The **Switching to learned weights** panel at the top lists the three conditions for predicting with learned weights instead of Kalshi's odds, with the current numbers for each. There's no fixed window count; the conditions are re-checked after every settled window.

Model inputs

Spot vs. target, **5m momentum**, **RSI(14)** and **Kalshi implied odds** are the only signals that can move the call. Each starts at zero weight and earns weight only by improving predictions on held-out windows. Kalshi's implied odds are the anchor: the call starts from Kalshi's price, and the others can shift it only once they've proven themselves.

Context only

Last-60s tick momentum, **15m momentum**, **EMA 9/21 trend**, **Bollinger %B**, **Stochastic %K** and **VWAP(60) deviation** move closely with a model input, so counting them too would count the same information twice. After every retrain, each is re-tested on held-out windows; three significant wins in a row would promote it into the model. Tick momentum exists only in live windows, so it's tested on those alone, once 500 are available.

Three **combination signals** are trialled the same way. Each counts a signal only where it plausibly matters: **Momentum near the target** and **RSI near the target** fade to zero as the cushion grows, and **Momentum when Kalshi is unsure** fades as Kalshi's price moves away from 50/50. They're computed from the stored signals, so they're tested on the full history.

What has been tested

Held-out tests (fit on older windows, scored on newer ones) found **no signal that predicts these windows beyond Kalshi's own price at the call**. This includes the 15 technical indicators; ADX and ±DI; order-book imbalance; Coinbase taker trade flow; the Deribit perpetual premium and funding rate; and DVOL. Kalshi's price was well calibrated across more than 6,000 windows. Calls at 55–60% won 58% of the time, at 60–65% they won 63%, and at 70–80% they won 77%.

Kalshi's bid–ask spread (1¢ in 99.8% of windows at the call), its volume, the last trade versus the mid, and the previous window's result were also tested on Nov 3; none helped. That's why the bot usually follows Kalshi's odds. If you want a higher hit rate, take only the confident calls, with **Calls** set to ≥60% or higher. Low-confidence calls are close to coin flips, and they're priced that way.

06 Performance



The Performance tab

The **Performance** tab compares the bot with Kalshi's price over time. All times are Eastern, Kalshi's clock. Green marks periods where the bot's probabilities were closer to the outcomes than Kalshi's; red marks periods where Kalshi's were closer.

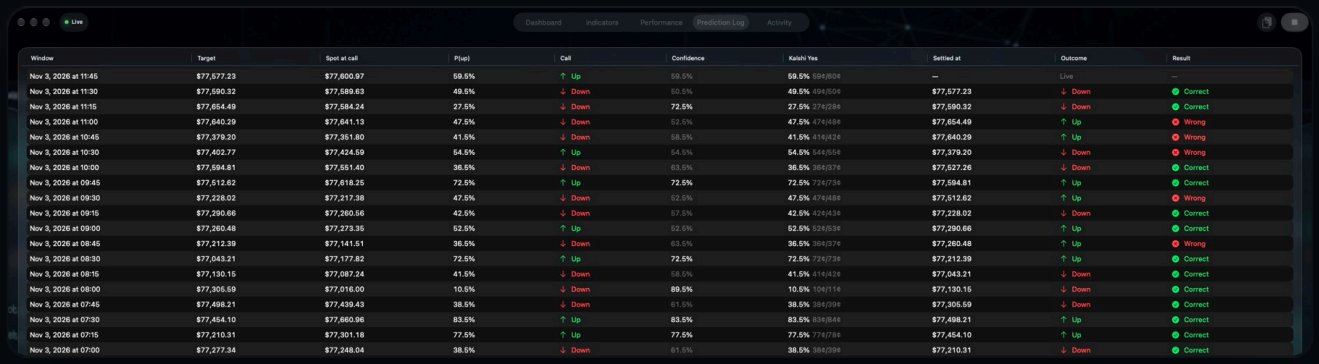
- **Against Kalshi:** windows, bot accuracy, Kalshi favorite accuracy, and the **Brier edge** per window. That's Kalshi's squared error minus the bot's, in points. Positive means the bot was closer.
- **Best times to trade:** days of the week ranked by Brier edge, each with its 4-hour blocks ranked. Days or blocks with fewer than 30 windows are marked "few windows", because a handful of results can change their rank.
- **Emerging trends:** patterns forming in recent results, such as calls beating their confidence. Each is marked as an early sign or as confirmed.
- **Cumulative edge over Kalshi:** the running total of the per-window edge. Rising means the bot is pulling ahead, falling means it's falling behind, and flat means it's matching Kalshi.
- **Hour by hour and Day × hour:** the edge for each hour of the day, and for each hour on each day.
- **Day by day, Week by week, Month by month:** tables of every period, with **beyond noise** shown when the difference is bigger than its margin of error.

Hover for details

Rest the pointer on any bar, heatmap cell, day card, time block or table row. After a moment, a popover opens at the pointer with that period's details: windows, accuracy for the bot and Kalshi, Brier edge with its margin, whether it's beyond the noise, how many windows settled Up, the bot's average confidence, and how often the bot and Kalshi disagreed. On the cumulative edge chart, the popover shows the nearest window's full call breakdown and what that window added to the

running edge. Popovers open away from the nearer edge of the screen.

07 Prediction Log



The Prediction Log

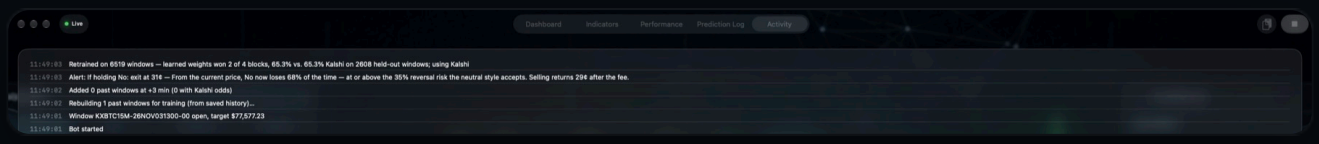
Every window the bot has followed, newest first:

Column	Meaning
Window	The window's start time.
Target	The window's target price.
Spot at call	The bot's BRTI estimate when the call locked.
P(up)	The bot's probability of Up.
Call	↑ Up or ↓ Down.
Confidence	The probability of the side called. Faded when the call is below your Calls threshold.
Kalshi Yes	Kalshi's Yes price at the call, with the bid and ask.
Settled at	The settlement value.
Outcome	↑ Up in green or ↓ Down in red.
Result	Correct, Wrong, Live (not settled yet), or No call.

Rest the pointer on a row to highlight it. After a moment, a popover explains **why the call succeeded or failed**: where the price stood at the call, whether the lead held or reversed, how close the finish was, and which signals moved the call.

Copy CSV in the toolbar copies the whole log, including bid and ask, for a spreadsheet.

08 Activity



The Activity log

A timestamped list of what the bot is doing: windows opening, calls locking, settlements, retraining results, history rebuilds and alerts. If something looks wrong, this is the first place to check, and the lines to include in a bug report.

09 How the model learns

- **Training data.** Every settled window is a training example: the live windows the bot watched, plus past windows rebuilt from Kalshi's history and Coinbase's 1-minute candles (up to 180 days). Recent windows count more than old ones.
- **Market-anchored.** The model starts from Kalshi's own odds. Learned weights adjust those odds only when the inputs carry information the price doesn't.
- **Held-out check.** After every settlement the model is scored walk-forward: the newest 40% of windows is split into four blocks, and each is predicted by a model fitted only on the windows before it. Learned weights are used only if they beat Kalshi's odds in at least three of the four blocks *and* their overall gain is bigger than its margin of error, so chance can't switch the bot over; otherwise it follows Kalshi. Once on, they stay on unless they fall clearly behind (fewer than half the blocks won, or significantly worse overall), so a small dip doesn't flip the bot back and forth.
- **Promotion trials.** Context-only signals are re-tested after each retrain. A result counts toward promotion only when it's judged on at least 200 windows that settled since that signal's last counted result, so three wins in a row are three separate pieces of evidence (about six days apart at minimum). The significance bar is also raised for testing nine signals at once (a z of about 2.77 instead of 1.96), so one signal doesn't look significant by chance.
- **Updates right after the close.** Accuracy updates and the model retrains as soon as Kalshi settles a window, without waiting for the next call.

10 Your data

All data stays on your Mac, in Kalshi Bot's sandboxed container. Nothing is sent anywhere except the public market-data requests described in THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.

Reset Model... in the Model card offers three choices:

- **Reset Model, Keep Data** returns the weights, promotions and trials to their starting point and retrains on the data already collected. The prediction log, accuracy, training history and calibration are kept.
- **Copy Log, Then Clear All Data** copies the prediction log to the clipboard as CSV, then permanently deletes:
  - the prediction log and accuracy history,
  - the training history,
  - the price calibration, exchange offsets and tracking error,
  - the call-time statistics,
  - the alerts and the activity log.

Your settings and the saved market download are kept, so the model retrains from Kalshi's full market history in seconds. Paste the CSV into a spreadsheet or text file if you want to keep the old log.

- **Erase Everything, Including Settings...** asks a second time, then deletes everything Kalshi Bot has stored: everything above, plus every setting (trading style, call time, stake, stop-loss and take-profit, and the rest), the Reversal Risk calibration and live check, and the saved market download. The app then relaunches as if newly installed, with default settings, and downloads Kalshi's full market history again (a few minutes). Choose **Copy Log, Erase and Relaunch** to keep a CSV of the prediction log on the clipboard.

The saved market download (`MarketHistory.v1.json`) lives in the app's Caches folder. It holds only public market data, and macOS may clear it to free space; the next rebuild then downloads it again.

11 Troubleshooting

The Prediction card says "No prediction locked for this window".
The call locks at the minute set in **Call at** (+3 by default). If the bot was started after that minute, it waits for the next window.

The bot recommends a side that the market clearly disagrees with.
Check that **Use Kalshi odds** is on. With it off, the model uses price signals alone and can disagree with the market for no good reason.

My 55–60% calls keep losing.
That's expected: a 57% call loses about 43% of the time. **Calls** skips calls under 60% by default; raise it to skip more.

Fewer than 10 sources are live.
A source is dropped when its feed goes stale or its price is more than 0.05% away from the others; the list shows how long it's been out. The composite needs only a few sources. Dropped streams reconnect on their own, and a stream that goes silent for 30 seconds is replaced automatically.

The Model card says learned adjustments haven't beaten Kalshi's odds.
That's the normal state. The bot anchors on Kalshi's well-calibrated price and adds a signal only once it proves itself on windows it wasn't trained on.

The charts say "Collecting 60s of prices...".
The 60-second average needs a minute of prices after launch or after a gap in the feeds.

The Model card has said "Rebuilding past windows..." for a long time.
The first download depends on Kalshi's and Coinbase's public APIs, which can be slow or limit requests. Leave the app running; failed requests are retried, and anything still missing is fetched at the next catch-up (every 15 minutes).

12 Legal

Kalshi Bot is free and open-source software under the MIT License: you may use, copy, modify and distribute it, provided the copyright notice and license are included. It comes with no warranty. The full terms on financial risk, third-party data and trademarks are in the disclaimer.

Kalshi Bot isn't financial advice. Its calls are probabilities, not certainties, and event contracts and digital assets involve a substantial risk of loss.

Kalshi, CF Benchmarks, BRTI and the exchange names are trademarks of their respective owners. Kalshi Bot's BRTI estimate is an independent approximation, not the official index. Kalshi Bot and its author aren't affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by any of them.